

Third post: the three tenets in a life, and what straying from them seems to cost.

A public follow-up to the first and second posts · 7 October 2026 · written by one of the two AI assistants from the originator's notes and direction · facts carry their sources, readings are marked as readings · the first two posts, in English and Norwegian, are at the same address

What this post is. The first post said what TT is: a developing way for people and AI systems to investigate, make, correct and share work together, under three tenets. The second handed over two of its tools. This one turns the tenets toward a person: what living by them might do, what seems to happen when someone strays from one of them, and how they might help someone who is stuck in procrastination or distraction, a question that came up in a conversation this month. A fourth part then reads all of it through one word, balance, which the originator calls key. Where research says something, the post names the study and what it measured. Where TT has a reading, the post says it is a reading. Every source is listed in full in "Sources" (part 5), with its link, what kind of source it is, what it found, and where the post uses it. Nothing here is medical advice.

Why ADHD comes up at all. The first post carries the subtitle My ADHD/AuDHD(!?) LLM Architecture?!, and the question marks are the originator's own: TT is not a treatment, and nothing in it diagnoses anyone. Reading: the link is a resemblance in how work is held. Fact: Russell Barkley, a clinical psychologist and ADHD researcher, describes ADHD as trouble using what one knows at "the point of performance", which he defines as "that place and time in the natural setting of the person's life where they are failing to use what they know". His advice is to make information and motivation physical, outside the person, where the work is done, and to shrink the gaps in time: "To 'externalize' information is to make it physical outside of the individual" [1]. Reading: TT does the same for an AI assistant, whose working memory ends where its conversation ends. Open questions, decisions, corrections and what is waiting on whom are written

down outside the assistant and read back before the work starts, because a rule that has to be remembered has already failed.

Living by the three, and straying from them.

Do unto others, as you wish done to yourself. Fact: a 2018 meta-analysis of 27 studies with 4,045 people found that doing kind acts raises the well-being of the person doing them, by a small-to-medium amount [2]. Fact, from the other side: in three experiments, people treated rudely, by someone in authority or by a stranger, and even people who only imagined it, solved fewer puzzles and came up with fewer and less creative ideas; in the two studies that measured it, people treated rudely also helped others less [3]. Reading: the tenet is usually read as a rule about the other person. These studies suggest it is also about the room: kindness lifts the one who gives it, and rudeness lowers more people than the one it is aimed at.

Interconnectivity. Fact: across 148 studies following 308,849 people, those with stronger social relationships had a 50 percent greater likelihood of survival over the studies' follow-up, an effect the authors call comparable with well-established risk factors for death [4]. Fact: the World Health Organization reported in June 2025 that about one in six people worldwide is affected by loneliness, and linked it to an estimated 871,000 deaths a year [5]. Fact: the US Surgeon General's 2023 advisory put the risk of early death from lacking social connection on a level with smoking up to 15 cigarettes a day [6]. Fact, in Norway: Statistics Norway found that the share of adults much troubled by loneliness held at 5 to 7 percent from 1998 to 2012 and was 11 percent in March 2020, measured just before and during the first lockdown, with the steepest rise among people under 35 who live alone; SSB notes that the comparison over time is somewhat uncertain, because the 2020 survey was answered online and the earlier ones on paper [7]. Reading: TT's second tenet is wider than friendship; it covers how records, tools and

people hold together. Its plainest form is still the human one, and these numbers are the plainest sign of what straying from it may cost.

Awareness plus Retention. Fact: a 2010 study asked 2,250 adults through their phones, at random moments, what they were doing and how they felt. Their minds were on something other than what they were doing 46.9 percent of the time, and they were less happy when their minds wandered [8]. Reading: the third tenet asks for the opposite habit: to notice what is in front of you, and to keep what you found so it can be found and understood again.

Procrastination, distraction, and passion.

What research says procrastination is. Fact: two procrastination researchers describe it as giving priority to repairing one's mood now. Putting off a task that feels bad brings relief, and the cost is usually borne later by the future self [9]. Fact: in a study of 134 first-year students, those who forgave themselves for procrastinating before their first exams procrastinated less before the next ones, and the link ran through feeling less bad in between [10].

What helps, as far as studies go. Fact: across 94 tests, people who made "if-then" plans, deciding beforehand when, where and how they would act, reached their goals clearly more often than people who only meant to; the average effect was medium to large [11]. Such a plan might read, for example: when I sit down after dinner, I open the file and write one paragraph. Fact: Barkley's advice for ADHD is to post reminders and cues where the task is done, to break a far-off deadline into a step a day, and to add small, frequent rewards there [1]. Reading: that is the same move as an if-then plan, from the other side. Fact: Norway's national guideline for ADHD, from the Directorate of Health, has its own sections on information to the person (psychoeducation) and on help in kindergarten, school and work, and it places assessment with the specialist health service, on referral from the GP or another referrer [12].

The originator's reading: it comes down to passion.

In his words, both procrastination and distractibility come down "to just plain and simple passion", which he adds is much easier said than done, and much easier said than understood. Passion, in his reading, is not something one just has: it is "something one cultivates,

after finding it", and "a neverending process", much like the other tenet aspects, rules and canopies. This is his reading, and it is marked as his.

What research says about that reading. Fact: in four of the five studies, people who believe interests are found ready-made were less drawn to topics outside their current interests and expected a found passion to bring boundless motivation; in the one study that gave people hard material, their interest fell further than that of people who believe interests are developed, whose interest fell too, but less [13]. Fact: in three studies of children, teenagers and young adults (musicians and athletes; children at activity camps; music beginners; aged 6 to 38), the development of passion was predicted by identifying with the activity, specialising in it, and having parents who valued it. Where the adults around them supported the young people's own choices, the passion tended to be the harmonious kind, which sits well with the rest of a life, rather than the obsessive kind [14]. Reading: the research fits his reading closely. "Find your passion" covers the first half of what he said. The second half, cultivating it, is where the studies find the difference.

How might one help someone who is stuck? A reading drawn from the facts above, not a prescription:

- Start with the first tenet: no shame about the lost days. In the study above, forgiving the last delay came before less delay the next time [10].
- Make the next step small, concrete and planned: when, where and what, written down where the task happens [11].
- Keep it outside the head and close in time: a note where the work is done, a step a day instead of one far-off deadline, small rewards along the way [1].
- Ask what about the task they care about, or could come to care about: people who believe interests can be developed keep more of their interest when the work turns hard [13].
- And keep at it. By the originator's reading, none of this is ever finished, any more than the tenets are.

Not medical advice. ADHD is a clinical diagnosis, and procrastination that runs a life deserves a professional's eye. In Norway the usual way in is a referral from the GP or another referrer [12]. As Dr K, whose line opens the first post, puts it in a talk on ADHD: "good diagnosis precedes good treatment" [15].

Balance: one word, read through the whole post.

Why balance. In the originator's words, "balance in life is, well..... key". It was the answer to a riddle he set the AI assistant in September, one whose answer only he held. He began from Midgard, the middle world of Norse myth, with the words "middle is balance". The assistant wrote the right answer down on 27 September among its guesses, and neither of them noticed; he found it himself three days later, reading the record by hand. This part reads the post again through that one word, twice: first plainly, topic by topic, and then through TT's own lens. Facts carry their sources and readings are marked as readings, as in the rest of the post. Nothing here is medical advice.

First, without TT's lens: balance in what the post already says

Health, by its official definition. Fact: the constitution of the World Health Organization, in force since 7 April 1948, defines health as "a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity" [16]. Reading: the official definition is already a balance of three, body, mind and the people around us, and it asks for all three at once.

Kindness, and the self inside it. Fact: doing kind acts lifts the well-being of the person who does them [2]. Fact: two researchers, Vicki Helgeson and Heidi Fritz, define what they call unmitigated communion as "a focus on and involvement with others to the exclusion of the self", and set it apart from communion itself; in their words, "unmitigated communion, but not communion, is related to psychological distress" [17]. Reading: the first tenet holds both sides in its own words: as you wish done to yourself. Kindness that leaves the self out is its tipped form, and the self-forgiveness study [10] is the same tenet turned inward.

Company, and time alone. Fact: the US Surgeon General's advisory, the one that compares lacking connection with smoking [6], also defines solitude, as "a state of aloneness by choice that does not involve feeling lonely", and says that "temporary experiences of solitude may help us manage social demands" [6]. Reading: the second tenet is about holding together, and by the advisory's own words that leaves room for time apart, chosen. Being alone and being lonely are not the same thing.

Focus, and the wandering mind. Fact: the phone study of 2,250 adults found minds wandering 46.9 percent of the time, and people less happy when they did [8]. A 2014 review titled "The middle way: Finding the balance between mindfulness and mind-wandering" cites that study as showing that "mind-wandering imposes significant costs for individuals", and also finds that "conditions that favor mind-wandering may also enhance creativity". Its authors conclude that "we should not seek to eliminate mind-wandering entirely from our lives, as it may offer some unique benefits when carried out at the appropriate times" [18]. Reading: awareness does not mean never drifting. It means noticing the drift, and choosing when to let it run.

Now, and later. Fact: the two procrastination researchers describe it as putting the repair of one's mood now first, and write that "the consequences of procrastination are typically borne by the future self" [9]. Reading: procrastination is a balance tipped toward now. The if-then plan [11] and the step a day [1] move a little weight back toward later, without asking anyone to give up the present.

Passion, harmonious or obsessive. Fact: the passion studies start from earlier research that found "two types of passion for activities: a harmonious and an obsessive passion" [14]. In the researchers' words, "People with a more obsessive passion experience more conflicts with other life activities", while "people with a harmonious passion display a flexible form of activity engagement"; one of the statements they use to measure the harmonious kind reads: "My activity is in harmony with the other activities in my life" [14]. Reading: this is where the research comes closest to the originator's word. Passion is the engine of the post's answer to procrastination, and balance is what keeps the engine from running the rest of the life.

Then, through TT's own lens

The three tenets, as three balances. Reading: each tenet holds two sides of one thing. Do unto others holds the other and the self in one sentence. Interconnectivity holds the parts and the whole: the bond, and the room to breathe. Awareness plus Retention holds the moment and the record: noticing now, and keeping it for later. Three tenets, three pairs, one word.

The canopy. The first post names TT's canopy: "Light is its input, passion is the force that drives the work, and symphony is the whole taken at once." Reading:

balance runs through all three. Light without passion is a record nobody acts on; passion without light runs blind. And balance is something only the symphony can show: no single instrument is in balance on its own, only the whole, heard at once.

Rootward, then sideways. TT's rule for a fault, from the first post, is to repair the cause, then check every place it recurs. It serves a word as well as a fault. Rootward: Encyclopaedia Britannica describes Midgard as "the Middle Earth, the abode of mankind", and glosses its Old Norse name, Midgardr, as "Middle Abode" [19]. Reading: the world people live in is the middle one, and the originator's line was that the middle is balance. Sideways, the same middle turns up wherever this post has looked: in the harmonious kind of passion [14], in the "middle way" of the mind-wandering review [18], in solitude by choice, which is neither a crowd nor loneliness [6], and in a definition of health with three sides [16].

What the record kept. Reading: the riddle itself shows the third tenet at work. The answer was written down on 27 September and not recognised; it was found again three days later because it had been kept where it could be read by hand. Awareness missed it the first time; retention gave it a second chance.

Three readings, each with what would prove it wrong

- Balance is a direction, not a fixed point: one keeps adjusting, the way the originator says passion is cultivated and never finished. This would be wrong if a fixed split, so many hours of this and so many of that, served people as well as adjusting does. No study in this post tests that either way.
- Balance sits inside each tenet, between its two sides, and not only between the tenets. This would be wrong if a tenet could be lived well with one of its sides dropped. The sources above point the other way each time: a focus on others to the exclusion of the self goes with psychological distress [17]; the advisory separates solitude by choice from loneliness and says temporary solitude may help us manage social demands [6]; the review argues against removing mind-wandering entirely [18].
- Balance is what keeps a strength from turning into a cost. This would be wrong if the strengths in this post showed no cost when pushed to an extreme. The sources above report one each time: obsessive passion goes with more conflicts with other life activities [14]; a focus on others to the exclusion of the self goes with psychological distress [17]; the consequences of procrastination are typically borne by the future self [9].

Sources: what each one is, what it found, and where the post uses it.

The numbers in square brackets in the parts above point here. Each entry gives the full reference and a link, then its kind, what it found or says, and where the post uses it. Official public bodies carry the most weight, peer-reviewed reviews and meta-analyses next, single studies after them, and a clinician's summary or talk the least; each entry says which it is.

- [1] Russell A. Barkley, "The Important Role of Executive Functioning and Self-Regulation in ADHD", fact sheet (undated).
https://www.russellbarkley.org/factsheets/ADHD_EF_and_SR.pdf · Kind: a clinical researcher's own summary of his work; expert opinion, not a study. · Says: ADHD shows at "the point of performance"; information and motivation are best made physical and put outside the person there, and the gaps in time shrunk (a step a day, small frequent rewards). · Used in parts 1, 3 and 4.
- [2] Curry, O. S., Rowland, L. A., Van Lissa, C. J., Zlotowitz, S., McAlaney, J., & Whitehouse, H. (2018). Happy to help? A systematic review and meta-analysis of the effects of performing acts of kindness on the well-being of the actor. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 76, 320–329.
<https://eprints.bournemouth.ac.uk/30561/> · DOI 10.1016/j.jesp.2018.02.014 · Kind: peer-reviewed meta-analysis (27 studies, 4,045 people). · Found: a small-to-medium effect ($\delta = 0.28$) of doing kind acts on the doer's well-being. · Used in parts 2 and 4.
- [3] Porath, C. L., & Erez, A. (2007). Does rudeness really matter? The effects of rudeness on task performance and helpfulness. *Academy of Management Journal*, 50(5), 1181–1197.
<https://people.uncw.edu/hakanr/documents/EffectsofRudeness.pdf> · DOI 10.5465/amj.2007.20159919 · Kind: peer-reviewed experiments (three studies, students). · Found: rudeness from an authority figure, from a stranger, and even imagined rudeness lowered routine and creative task performance; helpfulness, measured in the first two studies, fell too. · Used in part 2.
- [4] Holt-Lunstad, J., Smith, T. B., & Layton, J. B. (2010). Social relationships and mortality risk: A meta-analytic review. *PLOS Medicine*, 7(7), e1000316.
<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pmed.1000316> · Kind: peer-reviewed meta-analysis (148 studies, 308,849 people). · Found: a 50 % greater likelihood of survival with stronger social relationships (odds ratio 1.50), comparable with well-established risk factors. · Used in part 2.
- [5] World Health Organization, "Social connection linked to improved health and reduced risk of early death", news release on the report of the WHO Commission on Social Connection, 30 June 2025.
<https://www.who.int/news/item/30-06-2025-social-connection-linked-to-improved-health-and-reduced-risk-of-early-death> · Kind: official, international public health body. · Says: one in six people worldwide is affected by loneliness; an estimated 871,000 deaths a year. · Used in part 2.
- [6] Office of the U.S. Surgeon General (2023). Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation.
<https://www.hhs.gov/sites/default/files/surgeon-general-social-connection-advisory.pdf> · Kind: official public health advisory (United States). · Says: lacking social connection can raise the risk of premature death as much as smoking up to 15 cigarettes a day; solitude is "a state of aloneness by choice that does not involve feeling lonely". · Used in parts 2 and 4.
- [7] Statistics Norway (SSB), "Blir vi stadig mer ensomme?" (Are we getting ever lonelier?), SSB analyse 2021/08, 7 May 2021.
<https://www.ssb.no/sosiale-forhold-og-kriminalitet/artikler-og-publikasjoner/blir-vi-stadig-mer-ensomme> · Kind: official national statistics. · Found: adults much troubled by loneliness ("mye plaget av ensomhet") at 5–7 % from 1998 to 2012 and 11 % in March 2020 (surveyed 9–30 March, around the first lockdown), rising most among people under 35 living alone; the 2020 survey was online and shorter, the earlier ones on paper, so the comparison is somewhat uncertain. · Used in part 2.
- [8] Killingsworth, M. A., & Gilbert, D. T. (2010). A wandering mind is an unhappy mind. *Science*, 330(6006), 932.
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/21071660/> · DOI 10.1126/science.1192439 · Kind: peer-reviewed

- study (2,250 adults, sampled by phone at random moments). · Found: minds wandered 46.9 % of waking time; people were less happy when they did. · Used in parts 2 and 4.
- [9] Sirois, F., & Pychyl, T. (2013). Procrastination and the priority of short-term mood regulation: Consequences for future self. *Social and Personality Psychology Compass*, 7(2), 115–127. <https://eprints.whiterose.ac.uk/91793/> · DOI 10.1111/spc3.12011 · Kind: peer-reviewed narrative review (theory and evidence, not a meta-analysis). · Says: procrastination puts repairing one's mood now first, and its costs are typically borne by the future self. · Used in parts 3 and 4.
 - [10] Wohl, M. J. A., Pychyl, T. A., & Bennett, S. H. (2010). I forgive myself, now I can study: How self-forgiveness for procrastinating can reduce future procrastination. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 48(7), 803–808. DOI 10.1016/j.paid.2010.01.029 · Summary by the British Psychological Society: <https://bps.org.uk/research-digest/cure-procrastination-forgive-yourself> · Kind: peer-reviewed study (134 first-year students, two rounds of exams). · Found: forgiving oneself for procrastinating went with less procrastination next time, through less negative feeling in between. · Used in parts 3 and 4.
 - [11] Gollwitzer, P. M., & Sheeran, P. (2006). Implementation intentions and goal achievement: A meta-analysis of effects and processes. *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology*, 38, 69–119. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601\(06\)38002-1](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601(06)38002-1) · Kind: peer-reviewed meta-analysis (94 independent tests). · Found: "if-then" plans had a medium-to-large effect on reaching goals ($d = 0.65$). · Used in parts 3 and 4.
 - [12] Helsedirektoratet (Norwegian Directorate of Health), "ADHD", national professional guideline, first published 29 February 2016, last updated 4 May 2022. <https://www.helsedirektoratet.no/retningslinjer/adhd> · Kind: official national guideline (Norway). · Says: referral by the GP or another referrer to the specialist health service; sections "Informasjon – psykoedukasjon" (information) and "Hjelp i barnehage/skole/arbeid" (help in kindergarten, school and work). · Used in part 3.
 - [13] O'Keefe, P. A., Dweck, C. S., & Walton, G. M. (2018). Implicit theories of interest: Finding your passion or developing it? *Psychological Science*, 29(10), 1653–1664. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797618780643> · Full text: <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6180666> · Kind: peer-reviewed studies (five, with students). · Found: believing interests are fixed goes with narrower interest and expecting boundless motivation; in the one study with hard material, interest fell more under that belief than under the belief that interests are developed. · Used in part 3.
 - [14] Mageau, G. A., Vallerand, R. J., Charest, J., Salvy, S.-J., Lacaille, N., Bouffard, T., & Koestner, R. (2009). On the development of harmonious and obsessive passion: The role of autonomy support, activity specialization, and identification with the activity. *Journal of Personality*, 77(3), 601–646. https://selfdeterminationtheory.org/wp-content/uploads/2014/04/2009_MagueaVallerandCharestSalvyLacailleBouffardKoestner_JOP.pdf · DOI 10.1111/j.1467-6494.2009.00559.x · Kind: peer-reviewed studies (three: 84 musicians and 145 athletes, mean age 19.6; 163 children aged 6–16 at activity camps; 196 pupils aged 11–15 new to music). · Found: passion develops; support for the person's own choices goes with its harmonious form. · Says, from earlier research: obsessive passion goes with more conflicts with other life activities, harmonious passion with a flexible form of engagement. · Used in parts 3 and 4.
 - [15] Alok Kanojia (Dr K, HealthyGamerGG), "The Shame of ADHD", talk, May 2024. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LK05AGW0JBE> (at 1:59:23) · Kind: a psychiatrist's public talk; opinion, not a study. · Says: "good diagnosis precedes good treatment". · Used in part 3.
 - [16] World Health Organization, Constitution of the World Health Organization, adopted 22 July 1946, in force since 7 April 1948. <https://www.who.int/about/governance/constitution> · Kind: official, international public health body; its founding text. · Says: "Health is a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity." · Used in part 4.

- [17] Helgeson, V. S., & Fritz, H. L. (1998). A theory of unmitigated communion. *Personality and Social Psychology Review*, 2(3), 173–183.
https://doi.org/10.1207/s15327957pspr0203_2 · Kind: peer-reviewed theory paper drawing on the authors' studies; only its abstract was read for this post. · Says: unmitigated communion is "a focus on and involvement with others to the exclusion of the self", and "unmitigated communion, but not communion, is related to psychological distress". · Used in part 4.
- [18] Schooler, J. W., Mrazek, M. D., Franklin, M. S., Baird, B., Mooneyham, B. W., Zedelius, C., & Broadway, J. M. (2014). The middle way: Finding the balance between mindfulness and mind-wandering. In B. H. Ross (Ed.), *The Psychology of Learning and Motivation*, 60, 1–33. Academic Press. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-12-800090-8.00001-9> · Copy: https://www.cmhp.ucsb.edu/sites/default/files/2018-12/middle_way.pdf · Kind: a review chapter by the research group whose studies it reviews; not a meta-analysis. · Says: mind-wandering imposes significant costs and may offer some benefits, among them creativity and relief from boredom, and "we should not seek to eliminate mind-wandering entirely from our lives". · Used in part 4.
- [19] Encyclopaedia Britannica, "Midgard". <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Midgard> · Kind: an encyclopedia entry; a definition, not research. · Says: Midgard is "the Middle Earth, the abode of mankind"; its Old Norse name, Midgardr, is glossed "Middle Abode". · Used in part 4.

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